

ALGOTHON'26

OFFICIAL RULE BOOK

ORGANIZED BY AlgoXilla
12-HOUR ONLINE HACKATHON 04 October 2026
Participation: Individual or Team of 2 Registration: Free

IMPORTANT: By participating in ALGOTHON'26, every participant agrees to follow this Rule Book, the official submission instructions, and all organizer decisions made for event integrity and fairness.

This document is the official participant-facing rule reference for ALGOTHON'26.

1. Event Overview

ALGOTHON'26 is a 12-hour online hackathon organized by **AlgoXilla**. Participants will receive the official challenge/problem statement at the beginning of the hackathon and will develop and submit a working solution within the announced time window.

- **Mode:** Online
- **Date:** 04 October 2026
- **Hackathon start:** 10:00 AM
- **Development/submission window:** 10:00 AM to 10:00 PM
- **Final project submission:** By 11:00 PM
- **Results:** 05 October 2026 at 8:30 PM
- **Participation:** Individual or team of maximum 2 members
- **Registration fee:** Free

2. Eligibility & Participation

- A participant must be registered through the official ALGOTHON'26 registration process.
- A participant may participate individually or with one teammate. Maximum team size is 2.
- Each participant is responsible for providing accurate registration details.
- Participants must remain reachable through the official communication channels during the event.
- Joining the official WhatsApp community is mandatory for receiving important hackathon updates, announcements and instructions.
- Participation certificates are subject to the eligibility and completion requirements communicated by the organizers.

3. Hackathon Timeline & Deadlines

Time / Date	Activity
04 Oct • 10:00 AM	Hackathon begins and challenge/problem statement is released.
04 Oct • 10:00 AM–10:00 PM	Development / implementation period.
04 Oct • 10:00 PM	Development period ends.
04 Oct • 11:00 PM	Final submission deadline. All projects must be submitted by this time.
05 Oct • 8:30 PM	Results announcement followed by the celebration meet.

Deadline rule: Participants should not wait until the final minutes to upload their project. Technical or internet issues near the deadline do not automatically qualify a participant for an extension.

4. Problem Statement & Development Rules

- The official challenge/problem statement will be released at the start of the hackathon.
- Participants must build their project in response to the official challenge.

- Work submitted must be the participant's/team's own work or clearly disclose any permitted third-party components.
- Participants may use publicly available libraries, frameworks, APIs, datasets and development tools, provided their usage complies with the relevant licenses and the hackathon rules.
- AI-assisted development tools may be used unless a specific challenge instruction says otherwise. Participants remain responsible for the originality, functionality, accuracy and licensing of their submission.
- Do not submit a project that was substantially completed before the hackathon unless the organizers explicitly permit a pre-existing base/template.
- Any pre-existing code, templates, open-source components or third-party assets that materially contribute to the project should be disclosed in the submission where applicable.

5. Submission Rules

- Every team must submit the project through the official submission method/form provided by the organizers.
- The submission should include the required project details, team details, project link/demo link and any other fields requested by the organizers.
- The submitted project must be accessible to the judges. Broken links, private repositories or inaccessible demos may affect evaluation.
- If a GitHub repository is required, ensure that the repository contains the relevant source code and a clear README.
- The README should explain the problem addressed, solution, key features, setup/usage instructions and relevant technologies.
- Participants should clearly mention external APIs, datasets, libraries, assets and AI tools used where relevant.
- Only the final submitted version will be considered for evaluation.
- Late submissions may be rejected or treated as ineligible at the organizers' discretion, especially where the delay violates the announced deadline.

6. Judging & Evaluation

Projects will be evaluated by the judging team according to the criteria communicated by the organizers. Depending on the challenge, evaluation may consider factors such as:

- **Problem relevance:** How directly the project addresses the given challenge.
- **Innovation:** Originality and creativity of the idea or implementation.
- **Functionality:** Whether the core solution works as intended.
- **User experience:** Usability, clarity and overall product experience.
- **Technical implementation:** Quality and appropriateness of the technical approach.
- **Completeness:** Overall polish, documentation and quality of the submitted solution.
- **Presentation/demo:** Ability to clearly communicate the solution and demonstrate the working product.

The organizers/judges may request clarification or a demonstration where necessary. Judges' decisions regarding the final results are final for the event.

7. Code of Conduct

- Participants must behave respectfully toward organizers, judges, mentors, partners and other participants.

- Harassment, hate speech, threats, discrimination, abusive language or targeted misconduct are not permitted.
- Do not disrupt the event, submission system, communication channels or other participants' work.
- Do not attempt to exploit, attack, overload or gain unauthorized access to hackathon systems, forms, websites, servers or accounts.
- Do not impersonate another participant, organizer, judge or partner.
- Official announcements from the organizing team should be treated as authoritative for event logistics.

8. Academic Integrity, Originality & Fair Play

- Plagiarism, fraudulent submissions and misrepresentation of authorship are prohibited.
- Submitting another person's project as your own is prohibited.
- Using unauthorized leaked problem statements, private materials or confidential information is prohibited.
- Collusion intended to unfairly influence judging or circumvent team-size restrictions is prohibited.
- If a project uses substantial third-party code or assets, the source/license should be acknowledged appropriately.

9. Disqualification

A participant or team may be disqualified if the organizers determine that there has been a serious violation of the rules. Examples include:

- Plagiarism or fraudulent representation of work.
- Manipulation of submissions, judging or registration information.
- Unauthorized access, attacks or abuse of hackathon systems.
- Violation of the maximum team size or participation restrictions.
- Submission of prohibited or unlawful content.
- Serious misconduct toward participants, organizers, judges or partners.
- Failure to provide required information when requested for verification.

10. Technical & Submission Responsibility

- Participants are responsible for maintaining backups of their source code and project files.
- Participants should test their submission before the deadline.
- Internet connectivity, device failure, local software issues or last-minute upload problems are the participant's responsibility unless the organizers officially announce otherwise.
- If a platform or submission issue affects multiple participants, the organizers may announce an appropriate resolution through the official communication channels.

11. Communication & Official Updates

- Important updates will be shared through the official ALGOTHON'26 communication channels.
- Participants should regularly check the official WhatsApp community and other channels specified by AlgoXilla.
- Participants are responsible for following the latest official instructions and deadline updates.
- Do not rely on unofficial screenshots, forwarded messages or third-party claims when they conflict with an official announcement.

12. Prizes, Certificates & Recognition

- Prizes and recognition are subject to the final eligibility and judging results.
- Prize details communicated in the official event materials are subject to applicable organizer/partner terms.
- Certificates, where applicable, will be issued according to the eligibility/completion criteria communicated by the organizers.
- The organizers may verify participant/team details before issuing prizes or certificates.

13. Organizer Rights

- AlgoXilla reserves the right to interpret these rules for the purpose of maintaining fairness and event integrity.
- The organizers may modify event logistics, timelines or submission procedures when necessary and will communicate material changes through official channels.
- The organizers may remove or reject submissions that violate these rules or applicable laws.
- The organizers may use submitted project names, screenshots, descriptions and publicly shareable project information for event documentation and promotional purposes, subject to applicable permissions.

FINAL REMINDER

**Build fairly. Submit on time. Keep your project accessible. Follow official updates.
Respect the community.**